

2. **Alcohol.** There's no kind way to say this: If you're drinking every night, you're an idiot. I was once an idiot, too, by the way. Relaxing over an occasional cocktail is one thing; drinking like there's no tomorrow is another. Frequent alcohol use has an excellent track record of burning holes in wallets. Have you been to a bar lately? Even five bucks is way too much for a beer, and don't even get me started on \$14 "signature cocktails." I can't justify paying that much to slowly kill myself, and neither should you. You've just carved a path from your wallet directly into the alcohol companies' bank accounts. If you refuse to quit, you should be saving an equivalent of what you spend on alcohol into your Catastrophe Cash account. You're going to need it when you get cirrhosis and can no longer work and your children haven't saved enough to bury you properly. Sorry to be grim, but you know it's true. If you really think you have a problem, get help as soon as possible. Lighten up on the booze and your money will thank you. So will your liver.
3. **Coffee/Lunches.** Speaking of moronic, it never fails to amaze me when I see young interns and assistants paying \$25 a day on fancy coffees and lunches, when I know it took them the better part of the morning to earn it. So I can't stress this enough: Take the time and put in the effort to make your own coffee and lunches at home! Invest in a thermos, a vinyl lunch bag, and a good coffee maker. Because I'm not exaggerating when I say this: Lunch and coffee spending are the kind of insidious, daily expenditures that erode wealth and can affect your quality of life down the road.

There is always a cheaper way to enjoy your life, one that won't take away any of the pleasures and won't create more financial pain down the line. In fact, being frugal increases your sense of economic security and overall quality of life. That's the only way to experience the kind of joy only truly financially stable people get to feel. You can take this a step further. After becoming keenly aware of the Ghost Money